

The Echo Box

Family Emergency Binder Full Kit

The one file your family opens when something happens. Fill this out once, print it, and put it where your spouse, adult child, caregiver, or trusted contact can find it.

Use this for: emergency contacts, doctors and medications, insurance, bills, subscriptions, pets, home instructions, document locations, care preferences, and a personal note.

Important: this binder is an organization and communication tool. It is not legal, medical, financial, tax, or estate planning advice. It does not replace a will, power of attorney, advance directive, insurance policy, or professional advice.

Quick Start

Do not try to make this perfect. A half-complete binder your family can find is better than a perfect binder nobody knows exists.

	Item	Notes
[]	Print one copy of this binder.	
[]	Fill out the first two pages today.	
[]	Put it in a folder labeled Family Emergency Binder.	
[]	Tell one trusted person where it is.	
[]	Set a calendar reminder to review it every 6 months.	

Where this binder is kept

Location	
Backup location	
Who knows about it	
Last updated	

Emergency Contacts

List the people your family should call first. Include at least one person who lives nearby.

Contact 1

Name	
Relationship	
Phone	
Email	
Address	
When to call this person	

Contact 2

Name	
Relationship	
Phone	
Email	
Address	
When to call this person	

Contact 3

Name	
Relationship	
Phone	
Email	
Address	
When to call this person	

Contact 4

Name	
Relationship	
Phone	
Email	
Address	
When to call this person	

Doctors And Medications

Primary care and key doctors

Doctor 1	
Specialty	
Phone	
Office / portal	
Notes	

Doctor 2	
Specialty	
Phone	
Office / portal	
Notes	

Doctor 3	
Specialty	
Phone	
Office / portal	
Notes	

Doctor 4	
Specialty	
Phone	
Office / portal	
Notes	

Medication list

Medication	Dose	When	Prescriber	Notes

Insurance And Medical Details

Health insurance company	
Member ID / group number	
Pharmacy	
Preferred hospital	
Allergies	
Important diagnoses	
Medical devices	
Where insurance cards are kept	

Care preferences

Use plain language here. For legally binding care instructions, talk to a qualified professional about advance directives or medical power of attorney.

Who should be involved	
What matters most to me	
Religious or cultural preferences	
Other notes	

Bills, Subscriptions, And Accounts

Do not write passwords here if the binder will be widely accessible. Write where the password manager or sealed password record can be found.

Company / bill	Due date	Amount	How paid	Login or where to find it

Important Documents

	Item	Notes
[]	Driver license / ID	
[]	Birth certificate	
[]	Marriage certificate	
[]	Social Security card	
[]	Passport	
[]	Will or estate documents	
[]	Power of attorney	
[]	Advance directive	
[]	Life insurance policy	
[]	Home deed / lease	
[]	Car title / loan documents	
[]	Tax records	

Safe / lockbox location	
Attorney contact	
Financial advisor contact	
Tax preparer contact	

Home, Pets, And Daily Life

Alarm / entry instructions	
Landlord / HOA / building contact	
Utilities	
Vehicles	
Mail / packages	
Plants / home care	

Pet care

Pet names	
Veterinarian	
Food / medication	
Daily routine	
Emergency caregiver	

What I Want My Family To Know

This page is optional. Keep it practical, honest, and kind. You can write a few lines now and replace it later.

If something happens, please know	
People I want contacted	
Things I do not want you to worry about	
A message I want you to keep	

Talk To Your Parent Tonight Script

Use this if you are helping a parent, spouse, or older relative start the binder without making it feel scary.

Open gently: I am not trying to take over anything. I just realized that if there were an emergency, I would not know who to call or where anything is.

Make it practical: Can we write down the basics together? Doctors, medications, insurance, bills, and where important papers are. It would help me handle things calmly if anything ever happened.

Lower the pressure: We do not need to finish today. If we fill out the first page, that is already a win.

Questions to ask

	Item	Notes
[]	Who should I call first in an emergency?	
[]	Who are your main doctors?	
[]	What medications do you take every day?	
[]	Where are your insurance cards?	
[]	What bills must be paid every month?	
[]	Where are important documents kept?	
[]	Who takes care of pets or the house if you are away?	
[]	Is there anything you want us to know, but never found the right moment to say?	

Update Checklist

Review this binder every 6 months, after a move, after a new diagnosis, after a new insurance plan, or after a major family change.

	Item	Notes
[]	Contacts still current	
[]	Doctors and medications updated	
[]	Insurance information current	
[]	Bills and subscriptions current	
[]	Document locations still accurate	
[]	Pet and home instructions current	
[]	Trusted person still knows where binder is	
[]	Old printed copies removed or replaced	

Reviewed by	
Review date	
Next review date	
Notes	